

App to detect Sarcasm

God bless those Cornell University student to create an app that detects sarcasm.
<http://dgit.in/SarcasmApp>

SONY

Sony's Portable Projector

Sony launches LSX-P1 a new projector that weighs about two pounds in weight, now thats a portable theatre.
<http://dgit.in/PortableTheatre>



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How does OnePlus manage to provide budget handsets?

The makers behind the Flagship Killer of 2014, OnePlus has been churning out phones at surprisingly cheaper rates. We look at the various factors that enable it



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Introduction

Right. I'm pretty sure you've all noticed it by now. OnePlus is all over the place. Their smartphones are all over the internet, and it's no surprise why. OnePlus has been able to release *very* budget-friendly smartphones since the company's rise in 2013.

And hey, I'm talking full-fledged flagships.

Not those mundane mid-rangers.

If you've been living under a rock for the past couple of years, let me recapitulate.

OnePlus was founded by Pete Lau, in the year 2013. If that name rings a bell, he was the vice president of the Chinese mobile giant, OPPO. So, how budget-friendly are their smartphones?

Their first smartphone, the OnePlus One, had the same (if not better) top-notch specs of the flagships of the year 2014. But, here's the catch. It was priced aggressively at just \$299 for their base model. That's less than half of the 2014 Samsung flagship, the Galaxy S5!

The OnePlus Two is no exception, priced competitively at \$329. They've also just recently released their new mid-ranger, the OnePlus X, which is available for \$299. So, I suppose you can probably see where this is going.

Today, I hope to tackle the question of *how* OnePlus manages to perform this seemingly impossible feat.

Content

OnePlus' cheaper handsets are a culmination of a myriad of factors. To explain, there are a couple of business terms I would want to introduce. So, bear with me here. Let's begin with the most important one.

Margins

Let's start this off with a basic question. What in the world are margins and why do they matter?

Margins are the difference in price between the cost of what it actually takes to make a product, and the price it's sold for. In layman's terms,

Retail price – cost price = margins

Where, *retail price* is the cost at which the product is sold, *cost price* is the cost at which the product is manufactured, and that extra money left behind are the *margins*. Obviously, a company needs margins to make profit. But, not all of that profit is actually, well, profit. What I mean is, the extra money used by the company for research, marketing, and advertising, *especially* advertising, is added to the retail cost of the product.

A company like Samsung, for example, have way bigger margins for their flagships. Therefore, they can spend money on those extra needs. Plus, they can also increase their income.

In an interview with TechRadar, Pete Lau said, "*We are selling the phone at cost. We are able to do that by redistributing our costs to better benefit the user.*"

What Pete means is that they don't have over-the-top margins for their smartphones. Google is able to feed off their iconic and budget Nexus line because they earn through various other sources, such as the Play Store, for example.

But, then, how does OnePlus survive? Advertising, retailing, and marketing is where a company like OnePlus cuts corners. But, how do they do that? Let's go over their cost-cutting measures, shall we?

